

Introduction to Human Communication: COMM 108
Lecture Notes Outline: Ch. 1 Communication Perspectives

I. Communication Defined:

Process of creating meaning through symbolic interaction

- **Any verbal or nonverbal behavior that has potential to stimulate meaning**

CONSIDERATIONS:

- Source oriented definition is narrow and is meant for marketing
- Receiver oriented is basically meant for taking meaning out of something
- If meaning is taken out of something communication occurred
- Relational things are receiver oriented
- Source oriented is largely legal
- A verbal altercation is receiver oriented unlike a legal situation because relationships work differently.
- Messages meant to deliver intent are source oriented

II. Transactional Model of Communication:

A.K.A the Simultaneous model of communication

Described as receiver oriented

a. Source:

- i. **Source: person message originates from**
- ii. **Source cannot be an intended communication**

b. Receiver:

- i. **person who interprets *a* message**

c. Message:

- i. **A message is meaning that can be made from an intended or unintended source**
- ii. **Verbal is the use of language oral or written**
- iii. **Nonverbal is anything that isn't language-based communication**
- iv. **Our thoughts are connected to words we use**
- v. **Pay attention to the nonverbals for understanding emotions (affective components)**

- d. **Channel (Mediated):**
 - i. Channel refers to the means by which the message travels from the source to the receiver
 - ii. Verbal or non-verbal communication
- e. **Feedback:**
 - i. A receiver's overt response to a sources message
 - ii. What we can observe in an interaction
 - iii. There is always more behind someone's communication
- f. **Encoding:**
 - i. The Process of preparing messages
 - ii. Message creation: What are my ideas and goals
 - iii. Message adaption based on the receiver
 - iv. Message Transmission: How should I send the message
- g. **Decoding:**
 - i. Attempting to interpret or decipher a message
 - ii. To interpret or make meaning out of a message means to interpret it (Communication)
 - iii. Means of decoding:
 - 1. Sensation: one of our 5 senses (see, touch, hear, taste, smell)
 - 2. Interpret it: What is the overall meaning of the message
 - 3. Evaluate it: Does the message hold any value to me?
 - 4. Non-Response: What if I do not respond?
 - iv. Decoding is done by all humans in any interaction
- h. **Noise:**
 - i. Any element that interferes with the communication process
 - 1. Physical Noise: Loud people around you, noises, any external distractions
 - 2. Psychological Noise: A fight with your girlfriend affecting how you communicate, depression, you hate the person you are communicating with, etc.
 - 3. Physiological Noise: Hungry, Concussed, stubbed your toe, etc.
- i. **Context:**
 - i. Context refers to the environment that the communication takes place in
 - 1. Physical Context: Did you have the conversation in the parking lot or in an office?
 - a. Were there people around you?
 - b. Was it a formal conversation?
 - 2. Relational History: If I don't have a relationship with this person what is my set up, what is my set script?

- a. Do I have a positive or negative relational history with this person?
 - b. Do I have a mental script for each context?
- 3. What are the personalities involved in the context?
- 4. What is the cultural communication norm?

III. Communication Contexts:

A. Intrapersonal (Communication):

- a. DEF: Communication involving one person (YOU)
- b. How I communicate with myself
- c. Normal people have this
 - i. Normal is described as something experienced by most people
- d. What is going on in my head?
- e. If you have a verbal dispute, do you re-play what happened in your head and analyze the dispute?
 - i. Thinking about what you would change?
- f. Like when you go for an interview and practice what you would say

B. Interpersonal (Communication):

- a. A.K.A Dyadic communication
- b. DEF: Communication between two people
- c. Can be related to platonic or romantic relationships
- d. During interpersonal communication there can be a range of one to six dimensions of perception at play
- e. Examples of said dimensions (not limited to but included):
 - i. My perception of myself
 - ii. My perception of you
 - iii. Your perception of me
 - iv. Your Perception of Yourself
- f. These dimensions affect the meaning of the message

C. Small Group:

- a. DEF: A group of three to five
 - i. This range varies based on the source reaching up to a group of 12 people
 - ii. But the agreed upon starting point for a small group will always be three
- b. By the time a group reaches ~eight people the group will begin to devolve into cliques

D. Organizational (Communication):

- a. DEF: Communication that occurs within a structured collection of people working to achieve a collective goal

E. Public (Communication):

- a. DEF: The process of generating messages from a “single” source to a relatively large audience in-person
- b. Examples:
 - i. Giving a speech in class
 - ii. Presenting at a conference
 - iii. Marketing pitch
- c. Sometimes when we give a speech we don’t represent ourselves but an organization, that is why in the definition single is in quotes

F. Mass (Communication): NOT TESTED!!!!

- a. This is not yet a well-established context of communication
- b. DEF: The process of generating messages from a “single” source to a relatively large audience using technology
- c. This context is not well-established yet because the definition of technology is nuanced:
 - i. Technology can be a microphone, it can be a projector, a phone, a TV screen, etc.

IV. Other Notes:

- a. Is Communication a good thing?
 - i. It is not good or bad because it is a tool
 - ii. A tool that can be used to cause harm or to help someone
 - iii. Your response to this question should be “False” because something can also be deemed good or bad based on the quality
 - 1. For example, you can lose time because the conversation is of good quality